



A-level COMPUTER SCIENCE

Paper 1

June 2027

Preliminary Material

To be opened and issued to candidates on or after 1 September 2026, subject to the instructions given in the Teacher's Notes (7517/1/TN).

Note

- The Preliminary Material and Skeleton Program are to be seen by candidates and their teachers **only**, for use during preparation for the examination on **7 June 2027**. They **cannot** be used by anyone else for any other purpose, other than that stated in the instructions issued, until after the examination date has passed. They must **not** be provided to third parties.

Information

- A Skeleton Program is provided separately by your teacher and must be read in conjunction with this Preliminary Material.
- You are advised to familiarise yourselves with the Preliminary Material and Skeleton Program before the examination.
- A copy of this Preliminary Material and the Skeleton Program will be made available to you in hard copy and electronically at the start of the examination.
- A copy of the Data File **game1.txt** will be made available to you electronically at the start of the examination.
- You must **not** take any copy of the Preliminary Material, Skeleton Program or any other material into the examination room.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR CANDIDATES

Electronic Answer Document

Answers for all questions in all sections must be entered into the word-processed document made available to you at the start of the examination and referred to in the question paper rubrics as the **Electronic Answer Document**.

Preparation for the examination

You should ensure that you are familiar with the **Preliminary Material** and the **Skeleton Program** for your programming language.

Piles O' Tiles

Piles O' Tiles is a tile matching memory game.

The board consists of a two-dimensional grid containing piles of tiles. The tiles are face-down so players cannot see what is on the tiles.

Each tile has a symbol (an uppercase letter) and a points value.

Players take it in turn to choose two piles. The top tile of those two piles is turned over so that all players can see what is on those tiles.

If the two tiles have the same symbol on them then they are removed from the piles and the points for the two tiles are added to the player's score. The two tiles are then added to a discard.

If the two tiles do not have the same symbol on them then they are turned face-down again and put back on the piles they came from.

When the game ends the player with the highest score is the winner.

In the Skeleton Program the board is shown as a two-dimensional grid with x and y coordinates. Each pile is shown as an integer value that denotes the number of tiles currently in the pile.

Figure 1 shows a 6×6 board where most of the piles contain three tiles. The pile at (2, 5) has four tiles. The pile at (4, 5) has six tiles. The pile at (3, 2) has five tiles.

Figure 1

6	3	3	3	3	3	3
5	3	4	3	6	3	3
4	3	3	3	3	3	3
3	3	3	3	3	3	3
2	3	3	5	3	3	3
1	3	3	3	3	3	3
	1	2	3	4	5	6

In the Skeleton Program there is a default version of the game that uses a 6×6 grid. It is also possible to load a game from a file. The Data File **game1.txt** contains a game that can be loaded instead of using the default game.

Figure 2 shows the contents of the Data File **game1.txt**

Figure 2

```

16
2,A,1,E,1,H,3,J,2
0,E,1,Q,4,K,4,J,2,J,2
0,O,1,E,1,H,3
0,O,1,E,1,H,3
0,A,1,E,1,H,3
0,A,1,H,1,H,3
0,E,1,E,1,H,3
0,A,1,Q,4,F,3
0,U,1,E,1,H,3
0,A,1,E,1,H,3
4,U,5,E,1,K,4
2,A,1,K,4,H,3
0,A,1,E,1,K,1
0,R,1,K,3,H,3
0,R,1,F,3,K,7
0,A,1,E,1,H,3
2
Boris,0
Poppy,0

15
0
0

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END OF PRELIMINARY MATERIAL

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